

James Stirling

Inspired equally by Le Corbusier and the neoclassicists Schinkel, Friedrich Weinbrenner (1766–1826) and Gottfried Semper (1803–79), Glasgow-born James Stirling (1926–92) was arguably one of the most influential architects of his era. In the 1970s, he revitalized modernism using local materials and playful ideas, producing large-scale urban projects, including the Neue Staatsgalerie in Stuttgart in 1977–84. The undulating, dynamic building (opposite) is inspired by Schinkel's Altes Museum in Berlin (1828) and Wright's Guggenheim Museum in New York. His Clore Gallery (1980–7) for the Tate Britain in London is light, airy and minimalist, while his Tate Liverpool (1984) was formerly a seven-storey warehouse; leaving the exterior of the building almost untouched, Stirling transformed the interior into an arrangement of simple, elegant galleries. Stirling's final building, built on a wedge of land in the heart of the City of London, was the postmodernist No. 1 Poultry (1988–98); almost aggressively brash, it has a distinctive striped limestone façade, cylindrical clock tower and colourful courtyard.

